

6 Ans: B

Before coupling breaks,

$$F_{\text{net}} = ma$$

$$1.2 \times 10^5 = 2 (1 \times 10^5) a$$

$$a = 0.60 \text{ m s}^{-2}$$

After 20 s, both front and back carriages will be at $v = 0.60 (20) = 12 \text{ m s}^{-1}$

After coupling breaks,

$$F_{\text{net}} = ma$$

$$1.2 \times 10^5 = (1 \times 10^5) a$$

$$a = 1.2 \text{ m s}^{-2}$$

Using $s = ut + \frac{1}{2} a t^2$, calculate the distance travelled after coupling breaks for the 2 carriages separately

$$s_{\text{back}} = 12 (20) + \frac{1}{2} (0) 20^2 = 240$$

$$s_{\text{front}} = 12 (20) + \frac{1}{2} (1.2) 20^2 = 480$$

$$\text{Distance apart} = 480 - 240 = 240 \text{ m}$$